



General John C. Pemberton

Pemberton was a Northerner but chose to fight for the South in 1861—he believed in states' rights, and his wife was from Virginia. His unsuccessful defense of Vicksburg was his only significant part in the war.

The start of the siege

Believing correctly that his enemy was demoralized, Grant immediately ordered an attack in force on May 19. Union soldiers confidently charged forward but were greeted with walls of musketry fire from the well-protected Rebels. Nonplussed, Grant tried again on May 22, preceding the infantry assault with a massive artillery bombardment. The result: far worse Union casualties when lodgments initially secured by McClernand's corps went unexploited. Morale in Pemberton's army soared, but he failed to